

D293

Assessment and Learning Analytics

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

In a competency-based cybersecurity course that uses a popular video platform, one learner finished all 20 modules in two weeks but failed the performance task. Another completed only 8 modules but passed the task at the standard. Who has shown competence?

- A. Neither, until both finish all modules.
- B. Both, since each put in effort.
- C. The learner who finished all 20 modules.
- D. The learner who passed the performance task.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A training program for pharmacy technicians, which recently moved to a new campus, reports that a learner scored at the 90th percentile on a dosage test. The job requires 100% accuracy on dosage calculations. What does the percentile tell the employer?

- A. The learner got 90% of the items right.
- B. Only how the learner ranked against others, not whether the standard was met.
- C. The learner meets the 100% standard.
- D. The campus move affected scores.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A certification requires learners to perform CPR to a checklist standard, and everyone who meets it passes. What kind of assessment is this?

- A. Self-assessment.
- B. Graded on a curve.
- C. Criterion-referenced.
- D. Norm-referenced.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A budgeting skills assessment in an online course, built by a team with strong design awards, asks learners to plan costs for a Thanksgiving dinner with typical U.S. dishes. Many international learners score poorly. What is the best fix?

- A. Use a neutral or learner-chosen event so the task measures budgeting, not cultural knowledge.
- B. Keep it, since everyone gets the same task.
- C. Trust the design team's awards.
- D. Lower the passing score for international learners.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

An instructor in a large project-management certificate that runs every month wants learners to see exactly which parts of their project plans need work: scope, schedule, risks, and communication. Which rubric fits?

- A. A percentile rank among classmates.
- B. A holistic rubric with one overall score.
- C. An analytic rubric scoring each criterion separately.
- D. A checklist of whether each section exists.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Graders must place 500 short essays into pass or revise quickly, and learners will get detailed feedback later in a separate step. Which rubric fits this sorting step?

- A. No rubric, since speed matters most.
- B. A holistic rubric.
- C. A single-point rubric with notes on every criterion.
- D. An analytic rubric with eight criteria.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A learner submits a sales-pitch video in a course with a lively discussion board. Which feedback comment is most effective?

- A. "Post this on the discussion board."
- B. "Your opening names the customer's problem clearly (criterion 1). Next, add one number that shows the product's value before your close."
- C. "82/100."
- D. "Great job!"

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A customer-service course, hosted on a fast new platform, assesses whether learners can calm an upset caller. Learners must submit a 1,000-word written essay. Several learners with dyslexia score low despite strong role-play skills. What UDL-based change fits?

- A. Shorten the essay to 500 words.
- B. Move the course to a different platform.
- C. Lower the passing score for learners with dyslexia.
- D. Let learners show the skill through a recorded role-play scored on the same criteria.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A writing course assesses whether learners can write a clear argument essay. A learner asks to submit a video instead. What is the best response under UDL?

- A. Keep the written format, since writing is the skill, while offering supports such as planning tools or extra time.
- B. Grade the video on the same writing rubric.
- C. Accept the video, since UDL always allows any format.
- D. Excuse the learner from the assessment.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

On a 30-item quiz in a course that launched last spring, 36 of 48 learners answered item 12 correctly. The item has an eye-catching image. What is the item's difficulty index (p)?

- A. 0.25
- B. 1.33
- C. 0.40
- D. 0.75

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An item has a difficulty index of 0.40 for a group of 50 learners. How many answered it correctly?

- A. 30
- B. 125
- C. 20
- D. 40

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A dashboard, built with a costly analytics tool, shows one learner spent 6 hours on the pricing module, far above the 2-hour average. The manager says this proves the learner mastered pricing. What is the best interpretation?

- A. Time spent is a proxy; check it against assessment results, since long time may even signal struggle.
- B. Trust it because the tool was expensive.
- C. It proves mastery, because 6 hours is triple the average.
- D. It proves the learner is struggling and failed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

In a competency-based cybersecurity course ~~that uses a popular video platform~~, one learner finished all 20 modules in two weeks but failed the performance task. Another completed only 8 modules but passed the task at the standard. Who has shown competence?

Target word: what counts as competence **Decides:** Passing the performance task at the standard.

A	Inverted operation	Makes time and completion the gate again.
B	Adjacent category	Effort is not a competency standard.
C	Wrong stem number	Completion is not mastery.
D	Correct	Competence is demonstrated, not completed.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A training program for pharmacy technicians, ~~which recently moved to a new campus~~, reports that a learner scored at the 90th percentile on a dosage test. The job requires 100% accuracy on dosage calculations. What does the percentile tell the employer?

Target word: meaning of a norm-referenced score **Decides:** A percentile ranks against peers.

A	Confusion set	A percentile is not a percent correct.
B	Correct	Norm-referenced results do not show mastery of a fixed standard.
C	Inverted operation	Ranking high does not mean meeting the criterion.
D	Camouflage	Unrelated to what the score means.

3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

A certification requires learners to perform CPR to a checklist standard, and everyone who meets it passes. What kind of assessment is this?

Target word: classify from the scoring rule **Decides:** Fixed standard, everyone can pass.

A	Adjacent category	Scored by the learner, not against a checklist by an assessor.
B	Confusion set	Curves are norm-based.
C	Correct	Compares each learner to a fixed standard.
D	Inverted operation	That would rank learners against each other.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A budgeting skills assessment in an online course, ~~built by a team with strong design awards~~, asks learners to plan costs for a Thanksgiving dinner with typical U.S. dishes. Many international learners score poorly. What is the best fix?

Target word: culturally responsive fix **Decides:** The context requires culture-specific knowledge not tied to the skill.

A	Correct	Removes cultural knowledge that is not the skill.
B	Absolute language	Same task does not mean fair task.
C	Camouflage	Awards do not show fairness.
D	Inverted operation	Changes the standard instead of the barrier.

5. Answer C Concept 4

An instructor in a large project-management certificate ~~that runs every month~~ wants learners to see exactly which parts of their project plans need work: scope, schedule, risks, and communication. Which rubric fits?

Target word: rubric for detailed feedback **Decides:** Needs scores by criterion.

A	Adjacent category	Ranking is not rubric feedback.
B	Confusion set	Fast, but does not show which part needs work.
C	Correct	Shows strengths and gaps criterion by criterion.
D	Dropped element	Shows presence, not quality.

6. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

Graders must place 500 short essays into pass or revise quickly, and learners will get detailed feedback later in a separate step. Which rubric fits this sorting step?

Target word: rubric choice — reversed purpose **Decides:** Speed and one overall judgment.

A	Absolute language	A rubric keeps quick scoring consistent.
B	Correct	Gives one fast overall judgment.
C	Confusion set	Invites written comments, which slows the sort.
D	Inverted operation	Detailed but slow for a quick sort.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A learner submits a sales-pitch video ~~in a course with a lively discussion board~~. Which feedback comment is most effective?

Target word: best feedback **Decides:** Specific to criteria with a next step.

A	Camouflage	Not feedback on the work.
B	Correct	Specific, tied to criteria, and actionable.
C	Adjacent category	A score is not feedback.
D	Dropped element	No information on criteria or next steps.

8. Answer D Concept 6

A customer-service course, ~~hosted on a fast new platform~~, assesses whether learners can calm an upset caller. Learners must submit a 1,000-word written essay. Several learners with dyslexia score low despite strong role-play skills. What UDL-based change fits?

Target word: remove barrier, keep skill **Decides:** Writing is not the skill being assessed.

A	Wrong stem number	Keeps the writing barrier.
B	Camouflage	The platform is not the barrier.
C	Inverted operation	Changes the standard, not the barrier.
D	Correct	Removes the writing barrier while keeping the skill standard.

9. Answer A Concept 6 · transfer

A writing course assesses whether learners can write a clear argument essay. A learner asks to submit a video instead. What is the best response under UDL?

Target word: when flexibility does not apply **Decides:** Writing is the skill being measured.

A	Correct	Flexibility cannot remove the skill itself.
B	Confusion set	A video cannot show written argument skill.
C	Absolute language	UDL keeps the construct fixed.
D	Dropped element	Removes the measure entirely.

10. Answer D Concept 7

On a 30-item quiz in a course that launched last spring, 36 of 48 learners answered item 12 correctly. ~~The item has an eye-catching image.~~ What is the item's difficulty index (p)?

Target word: compute p **Decides:** $p = \text{correct} / \text{total}$.

A	Inverted operation	The share answering incorrectly.
B	Confusion set	$48 / 36$; divides the wrong way.
C	Wrong stem number	Uses $12 / 30$ from the item number and quiz length.
D	Correct	$36 / 48 = 0.75$; a fairly easy item.

11. Answer C Concept 7 · transfer

An item has a difficulty index of 0.40 for a group of 50 learners. How many answered it correctly?

Target word: solve for number correct **Decides:** 0.40×50 .

A	Inverted operation	The number answering incorrectly.
B	Confusion set	Divides 50 by 0.40.
C	Correct	$0.40 \times 50 = 20$.
D	Wrong stem number	Reads 0.40 as 40 learners.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A dashboard, ~~built with a costly analytics tool~~, shows one learner spent 6 hours on the pricing module, far above the 2-hour average. The manager says this proves the learner mastered pricing. What is the best interpretation?

Target word: meaning of activity data **Decides:** Time on page is a proxy, not proof.

A	Correct	Analytics add visibility and must be validated with evidence of learning.
B	Camouflage	Cost does not validate data.
C	Wrong stem number	More time is not evidence of skill.
D	Absolute language	Also overreads a proxy.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	5	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	4	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Competency-based assessment	Learners advance by demonstrating a defined competency to a set standard, and time is flexible; seat time or completion does not count as mastery.	Counting module completion or hours as proof of competence.	A learner who finished content vs. one who showed the skill.
2	Criterion- vs. norm-referenced	Criterion-referenced scores compare performance to a fixed standard; norm-referenced scores compare learners to each other (percentiles, ranks).	Using a ranking to decide whether someone meets a skill standard.	Whether the result says meets the standard or ranks against peers.
3	Culturally responsive assessment	Use contexts, examples, and language that do not favor one cultural background unless that background is what is being assessed, and offer varied ways to show learning.	Assuming a task is neutral because it is the same for everyone.	A scenario that depends on culture-specific knowledge not tied to the skill.
4	Rubric types	Analytic rubrics score each criterion separately and give detailed feedback; holistic rubrics give one overall score quickly; single-point rubrics describe proficiency and leave room for notes above or below.	Choosing a holistic rubric when learners need criterion-by-criterion feedback.	The purpose of scoring: fast overall judgment or targeted feedback.
5	Effective feedback	Feedback should be timely, specific to the criteria, and actionable, answering where am I going, how am I doing, and what is next.	Giving a score or generic praise with no next step.	A sample comment to judge.
6	UDL in assessment: remove access barriers	Keep the skill being measured fixed while removing barriers unrelated to it (for example, allow audio or video responses when writing is not the skill).	Lowering the standard itself in the name of flexibility, or keeping barriers that are not part of the skill.	A format requirement that may not be part of the competency.
7	Item analysis	Item difficulty (p) is the proportion answering correctly; discrimination compares high and low scorers, and a negative value flags a flawed item.	Reading p as how hard an item is on a scale where higher means harder.	Counts of correct answers on an item, overall or by group.
8	Analytics as a validation layer	Activity data (logins, clicks, time) are proxies that add visibility and help confirm or question assessment results; they do not prove learning on their own.	Treating high time-on-page as evidence of mastery.	Activity data used to claim learning.

Course scope (public description): Assessment and Learning Analytics focuses specifically on applying assessment and learning analytics practices to gauge learner progress through e-learning products. This course is

an introduction to assessment models, including competency and skills-based methods, as well as culturally responsive and Universal Design for Learning (UDL) approaches in assessment, rubric, and feedback design. Finally, this course introduces learning analytics, specifically how they can add an additional layer of validation and visibility on learner progress.